

HS-HU701 — Principles of Management

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Module 4 Exam Notes

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Contents

1	Customer Management	2
1.1	Market Planning and Research	2
1.2	The Marketing Mix — 4Ps	2
1.3	Advertising and Brand Management	3
2	Operations and Technology Management	4
2.1	Production and Operations Management	4
2.2	Logistics and Supply Chain Management	5
2.3	Total Quality Management (TQM)	5
2.4	Kaizen and Six Sigma	6
2.5	Management Information Systems (MIS)	7

1. Customer Management

Customer Management — Overview

Customer Management encompasses all strategies and activities through which an organisation attracts, retains, and grows its customer base. It includes market planning, research, the marketing mix, advertising, and brand management — all directed toward satisfying customer needs profitably.

1.1 Market Planning and Research

Market Planning and Marketing Research

Market Planning is the process of setting marketing objectives and devising strategies and tactics to achieve them. It involves analysing the market environment, identifying target segments, and allocating resources.

Marketing Research is the systematic gathering, recording, and analysis of data about problems relating to the marketing of goods and services. It bridges the gap between the organisation and its customers.

Steps in the Marketing Research Process:

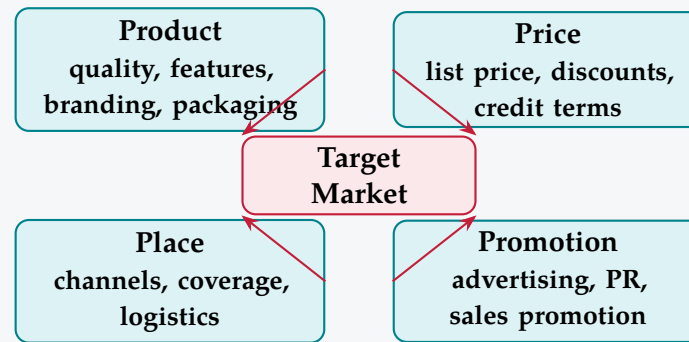
1. **Define the Problem and Research Objectives:** Clearly state what information is needed.
2. **Develop the Research Plan:** Choose data sources (primary/secondary), research methods (survey, observation, experiment), and sampling plan.
3. **Collect Information:** Gather primary data (questionnaires, interviews, focus groups) or secondary data (reports, databases).
4. **Analyse the Information:** Tabulate, cross-tabulate, and apply statistical techniques.
5. **Present the Findings:** Report actionable conclusions to management.
6. **Make the Decision:** Use findings to guide marketing strategy.

1.2 The Marketing Mix — 4Ps

Marketing Mix (4Ps)

The **Marketing Mix** is the set of controllable, tactical marketing tools that the firm blends to produce the response it wants in the target market. The four Ps are: **Product, Price, Place (Distribution), and Promotion.**

The 4Ps of the Marketing Mix



Element	Key Decisions	Examples
Product	Design, quality, features, variants, packaging, after-sales service.	iPhone with multiple storage options.
Price	Pricing strategy (skimming, penetration, competitive), discounts, payment terms.	Introductory low price for market entry.
Place	Distribution channels, intermediaries, logistics, coverage (intensive, selective, exclusive).	Direct online sale vs. retail chain.
Promotion	Advertising, personal selling, public relations, sales promotions, digital marketing.	TV ad campaign + social media promotion.

1.3 Advertising and Brand Management

Advertising and Brand Management

Advertising is any paid form of non-personal presentation and promotion of ideas, goods, or services by an identified sponsor through mass media (TV, radio, print, digital).

Brand is a name, term, sign, symbol, or design (or a combination) intended to identify the goods or services of one seller and to differentiate them from competitors.

Brand Equity is the added value a brand name gives to a product beyond its functional benefits.

Objectives of Advertising (AIDA Model):

- 1. Awareness:** Make the target audience aware of the product/brand.
- 2. Interest:** Generate interest by highlighting features and benefits.
- 3. Desire:** Create a desire/preference for the brand over competitors.
- 4. Action:** Motivate the consumer to purchase.

Brand building strategies:

- Consistent quality and customer experience across all touchpoints.
- Emotional brand associations and storytelling.

- Celebrity endorsements and influencer marketing.
- Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) initiatives that enhance brand image.

2. Operations and Technology Management

Operations Management — Definition

Operations Management (OM) is the administration of business practices aimed at creating the highest level of efficiency possible within an organisation. It is concerned with converting materials and labour into goods and services as efficiently as possible.

2.1 Production and Operations Management

Types of production systems:

Type	Description	Example
Job/Project Production	One-off, custom products made individually.	Ship building, construction.
Batch Production	Groups of identical items produced together in stages.	Bakeries, pharmaceuticals.
Mass/Flow Production	Continuous, standardised production of large volumes on assembly lines.	Car assembly, electronics.
Continuous Process	24/7 uninterrupted flow production.	Oil refinery, chemical plant.

Key decisions in Production/Operations Management:

- **Capacity planning:** Determining production capacity needed to meet demand.
- **Facility layout:** Arrangement of machines, workstations, and storage (process layout, product layout, fixed-position layout).
- **Aggregate planning:** Medium-term production scheduling to match supply with forecasted demand.
- **Inventory management:** Deciding optimal stock levels to balance holding costs vs. shortage costs.

Economic Order Quantity (EOQ)

The EOQ model minimises total inventory cost (holding + ordering):

$$Q^* = \sqrt{\frac{2DS}{H}} \quad (1)$$

Where:

Q^* = Optimal order quantity (units)

D = Annual demand (units/year)

S = Ordering cost per order (\$)

H = Annual holding/carrying cost per unit

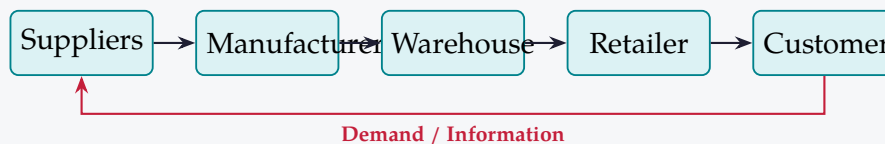
$$\text{Total Annual Cost: } TC = \frac{D}{Q}S + \frac{Q}{2}H$$

2.2 Logistics and Supply Chain Management

Supply Chain Management (SCM)

Supply Chain Management is the management of the flow of goods, services, information, and finances from raw material suppliers through manufacturers and distributors to the final end-user. The goal is to maximise customer value while minimising total system cost.

Basic Supply Chain Flow



Key logistics activities:

- Transportation (road, rail, air, sea selection).
- Warehousing and inventory storage.
- Order processing and fulfilment.
- Demand forecasting and supply planning.
- Reverse logistics (returns, recycling).

2.3 Total Quality Management (TQM)

Total Quality Management (TQM)

TQM is a management approach centred on quality, based on the participation of all members of an organisation, aimed at long-term success through customer satisfaction and benefits to all members of the organisation and society.

Core principle: Quality is everyone's responsibility, not just the quality control department.

Key principles of TQM:

- **Customer Focus:** Understanding and exceeding customer expectations.
- **Continuous Improvement (Kaizen):** Ongoing, incremental improvements in all processes.
- **Employee Involvement:** All employees contribute to quality improvement.
- **Process Approach:** Focus on improving processes to improve outputs.

- **Fact-Based Decision Making:** Use of data and statistical tools.
- **Supplier Relationships:** Mutually beneficial relationships with suppliers.

2.4 Kaizen and Six Sigma

Kaizen and Six Sigma

Kaizen (Japanese: “change for better”) is a philosophy of continuous, incremental improvement involving everyone in the organisation — from top management to shop floor workers. It focuses on eliminating waste (Muda) in all forms.

Six Sigma is a data-driven methodology for eliminating defects in any process. The goal is to reduce process variation to achieve no more than **3.4 defects per million opportunities (DPMO)**.

Kaizen vs. Six Sigma:

Aspect	Kaizen	Six Sigma
Origin	Japan (Toyota Production System)	Motorola (1986)
Approach	Incremental, continuous improvement.	Breakthrough improvement; eliminate root causes of defects.
Scope	Entire organisation; all processes.	Specific critical processes and projects.
Tools	5S, PDCA, Value Stream Mapping.	DMAIC, statistical tools (SPC, DOE).
Involvement	All employees (bottom-up).	Trained specialists (Black Belts, Green Belts).
Goal	Reduce waste; improve efficiency.	Reduce variation; achieve near-zero defects.

The DMAIC Cycle (Six Sigma):

1. **Define:** Define the problem, project scope, customer requirements (CTQs), and project goals.
2. **Measure:** Collect baseline data; quantify the current process performance.
3. **Analyse:** Identify root causes of defects using statistical tools (Fishbone diagram, Pareto chart, regression).
4. **Improve:** Develop, test, and implement solutions to eliminate root causes.
5. **Control:** Monitor the improved process to sustain gains using control charts and SOPs.

The PDCA Cycle (Kaizen / TQM):

1. **Plan:** Identify a problem; analyse causes; plan improvement.
2. **Do:** Implement the planned change on a small scale.
3. **Check:** Measure and evaluate results against the plan.
4. **Act:** Standardise the improvement if successful; repeat the cycle.

2.5 Management Information Systems (MIS)

Management Information System (MIS)

MIS is an integrated, user-machine system that provides information to support operations, management, and decision-making functions in an organisation. It collects data from internal and external sources, processes it, and presents it as structured reports and dashboards to managers.

Types of Information Systems:

System	Level	Purpose
TPS (Transaction Processing System)	Operational	Records daily routine transactions (sales, payroll).
MIS (Management Information System)	Middle management	Provides structured summary reports for routine decisions.
DSS (Decision Support System)	Middle/Top management	Supports semi-structured and unstructured decisions with models.
EIS/ESS (Executive Information System)	Top management	Strategic dashboards; external and internal data.
ERP (Enterprise Resource Planning)	All levels	Integrates all business functions (finance, HR, supply chain) in a single system.

Benefits of MIS:

- Facilitates faster and more accurate decision-making.
- Improves coordination and communication across departments.
- Provides real-time monitoring of business performance (KPIs).
- Reduces information redundancy and improves data integrity.

Quick Revision — Module 4

Customer Management, Operations, TQM, Kaizen, Six Sigma & MIS | HS-HU701

Key Formulas and Frameworks at a Glance

EOQ	$Q^* = \sqrt{2DS/H}$
Total Inventory Cost	$TC = (D/Q)S + (Q/2)H$
4Ps of Marketing	Product, Price, Place, Promotion
AIDA Model	Awareness → Interest → Desire → Action
DMAIC (Six Sigma)	Define → Measure → Analyse → Improve → Control
PDCA (Kaizen/TQM)	Plan → Do → Check → Act
Six Sigma Target	≤ 3.4 Defects Per Million Opportunities (DPMO)

One-Line Definitions

- **Marketing Mix (4Ps):** Controllable tools (Product, Price, Place, Promotion) blended to target a market.
- **Brand Equity:** Extra value a brand name adds to a product beyond its functional benefits.
- **Operations Management:** Converting inputs (materials, labour) into goods/services as efficiently as possible.
- **EOQ:** Order quantity that minimises the sum of annual ordering cost and holding cost.
- **Supply Chain Management:** Managing the flow of goods and information from supplier to end customer.
- **TQM:** Organisation-wide approach to embedding quality in all processes to achieve customer satisfaction.
- **Kaizen:** Continuous, incremental improvement involving all employees to eliminate waste.
- **Six Sigma:** Data-driven methodology targeting ≤ 3.4 DPMO through root cause elimination.
- **DMAIC:** Six Sigma improvement cycle: Define, Measure, Analyse, Improve, Control.
- **MIS:** Integrated system that provides managers with information for decision-making.
- **ERP:** Software that integrates all core business processes into a single unified system.

Frequently Asked / Viva Questions**Q1. What are the 4Ps of the Marketing Mix? Give one example for each.**

Product (iPhone), Price (penetration pricing), Place (online store), Promotion (TV advertisement).

Q2. What is the AIDA model in advertising?

AIDA stands for Awareness (make customers aware), Interest (highlight benefits), Desire (create preference), Action (prompt purchase). It describes the stages a consumer goes through from first exposure to buying.

Q3. What is brand equity and why is it important?

Brand equity is the added value a brand name confers to a product. It is important because it enables premium pricing, customer loyalty, and competitive advantage (e.g., Apple vs. a generic smartphone).

Q4. Define Supply Chain Management. Draw a simple supply chain.

SCM manages the flow of goods, services, and information from raw material suppliers to the final customer. Flow: Suppliers → Manufacturer → Warehouse → Retailer → Customer (with information flowing back).

Q5. State the EOQ formula and define each variable.

$Q^* = \sqrt{2DS/H}$. D = annual demand, S = cost per order, H = annual holding cost per unit. It gives the order quantity that minimises total annual inventory cost.

Q6. What is TQM? What are its core principles?

TQM is an organisation-wide philosophy to embed quality in all processes for long-term customer satisfaction. Core principles: customer focus, continuous improvement, employee involvement, process approach, data-based decisions, and supplier relationships.

Q7. What is Kaizen? How does it differ from Six Sigma?

Kaizen is continuous, incremental improvement through small daily changes involving all employees (bottom-up). Six Sigma is a project-based breakthrough methodology using statistical tools to reduce defects to 3.4 DPMO (specialist-driven).

Q8. Explain the DMAIC cycle used in Six Sigma.

Define (problem and CTQs) → Measure (baseline performance) → Analyse (root causes) → Improve (implement solutions) → Control (sustain gains with control charts and SOPs).

Q9. What is a Management Information System (MIS)?

MIS is an integrated system that collects, processes, and presents data as structured reports to support managerial decision-making at middle levels of the organisation.

Frequently Asked / Viva Questions (contd.)

Q10. How does an ERP system differ from an MIS?

MIS provides reports for management decisions; ERP integrates all business functions (finance, HR, production, supply chain) across the entire organisation into one unified database and application.

Q11. What is the PDCA cycle? Where is it used?

PDCA (Plan–Do–Check–Act) is a four-step iterative quality improvement cycle. Used in TQM and Kaizen to continuously improve processes, products, and services.

Q12. What is the difference between intensive, selective, and exclusive distribution?

Intensive distribution places products in as many outlets as possible (e.g., soft drinks). Selective distribution uses a limited number of chosen outlets (e.g., electronics). Exclusive distribution uses a single outlet per region (e.g., luxury cars, high-end watches).

TQM vs. Kaizen vs. Six Sigma — Quick Reference

Aspect	TQM	Kaizen	Six Sigma
Focus	Overall quality culture	Continuous small improvements	Eliminate defect root causes
Approach	Cultural/philosophical	Incremental (bottom-up)	Statistical/project-based
Cycle	PDCA	PDCA	DMAIC
People	Everyone	Everyone	Black/Green Belts
Target	Customer satisfaction	Waste elimination	≤ 3.4 DPMO